

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

The freedom to believe or not to believe.



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know anyone who believes something that you think is strange? What is it?
- What kinds of things do you believe that others might think are strange or untrue?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss coincidences and strange events.
- I can express opinions and beliefs about the solution to a problem.
- I can express that a fairly certain condition will be fulfilled.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa is still **skeptical** *of Peter's beliefs.

* "Skeptical" means doubting that something is true or useful.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Wow, Peter, I never expected you to know so much about astrology.
- Peter:** Ever since I started reading about Mercury retrograde, I've come to believe in it more and more. I really think there is validity to it. I can give you personal examples. If Mercury is in retrograde, your computer will malfunction. That has happened to me several times. If you try to plan any travel, there will be interruptions and delays. If you have to travel during Mercury retrograde, you should give yourself plenty of time and have a back-up plan.
- Vanessa:** You said Mercury retrograde also affects our minds.
- Peter:** Yes. If you need to make any big purchases, like a car or house, you shouldn't make them during this time. If it's just a small purchase, you can be less wary. If you need to sign any legal documents or contracts, you ought to wait until the retrograde is over. Essentially you shouldn't do or start anything new. It's a time for reconnecting with what you already have. If the retrograde happens during your astrological star sign, you will feel the effects of the retrograde more intensely than most people.
- Vanessa:** Don't tell me you believe in star signs too? Do you read your horoscope every day? And if your horoscope tells you to do something or avoid something, will you follow these commands?
- Peter:** No, I don't read the daily horoscopes but I believe that your birth date influences your behavior and personality traits. If you spend some time studying your sign and your own personality and relationships, you will see that there is some merit to astrology.
- Vanessa:** I don't know, Peter. I can't believe that there are only 12 types of people in this world. Does that mean I'm the same as every other Taurus?
- Peter:** At least consider Mercury retrograde. If you pay attention to when you have problems, you will see that there is a pattern.



Let's Practice!

If something bad can happen, it will.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Circle the incorrect words. Re-write the sentences correctly. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) If mercury is in retrograded, your computer will malfumction.

- 2) If you try to plan any travel, there will be interuptions and delays.

- 3) If the retrograde happens during your astrologycal starr sign, you will feel the effects more intenssely than most people.

- 4) If your horoscoped tells you to do something or avoid someting, will you follow these commands?

- 5) If you study your signature, you will see that there is some merit to astronomy.



Let's Practice!

Do horoscopes have some truth?

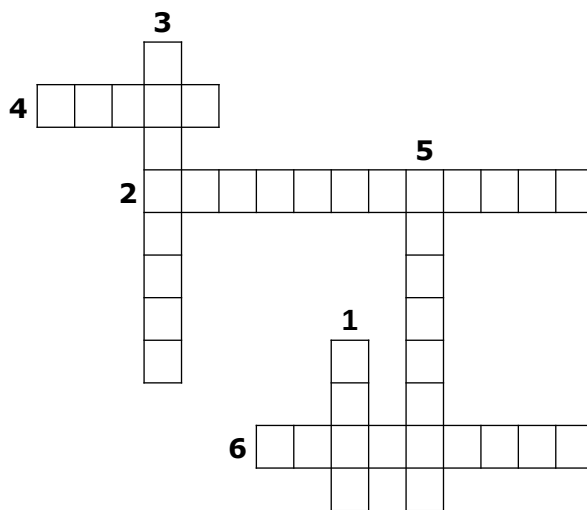
Instructions: Read the clues to complete the crossword. Write the words in the corresponding box.

Down

- 1) careful due to lack of trust or uncertainty.
- 3) truth; the state of being logically or factually sound.
- 5) item obtained with an exchange of money.

Across

- 2) when something stops another thing from happening for a short period.
- 4) period of time where something does not happen.
- 6) a description of what is going to happen to you, based on the position of the stars and planets at the time of your birth.





Extension Activity

Watch TED Talk: *Why People Believe Weird Things* (Michael Shermer)

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch the TED Talk: *Why People Believe Weird Things* (Michael Shermer)
- Take notes while you listen. Listen as many times as you need.
- Write down any new vocabulary you hear. Look up the meanings of the new words.
- Summarize your notes and write a paragraph about what you heard in the video.
- Present your paragraph to your class or group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch a TED Talk video and take notes.

☐
☐

I look up new vocabulary.

☐
☐

I summarize my notes and write a paragraph.

☐
☐

I present my paragraph to my group.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **wary** (adjective): careful due to lack of trust or uncertainty
e.g. If it's just a small purchase, you can be less wary.
- **interruption** (noun): when something stops another thing from happening for a short period
e.g. If you try to plan any travel, there will be interruptions and delays.
- **validity** (noun): the truthfulness of something that is logically or factually sound
e.g. I really think there is validity to it.
- **astrology** (noun): study of the movements and positions of the sun, moon, planets, and stars in the belief that they influence human behavior
e.g. I never expected you to know so much about astrology.
- **delay** (noun): period of time where something does not happen
e.g. There are always a lot of delays on the trains.
- **purchase** (noun): item obtained with an exchange of money
e.g. If you need to make any big purchases, like a car or house, you shouldn't make them during this time.
- **horoscope** (noun): a description of what is going to happen to you, based on the position of the stars and planets at the time of your birth
e.g. Do you read your horoscope every day?
- **daily** (adjective): every day
e.g. I don't read the daily horoscopes but I believe that your birth date influences your behavior and personality traits.





Learning Points

The First Conditional: Possibilities, Superstitions, Warnings and Threats

You use the first conditional to talk about a result that is likely to happen or is almost certain to happen in the future IF the condition in the *if* clause occurs.

The form of the first conditional is:

If + simple present, will + verb

You can use the first conditional to talk about

1. Possibilities in the present or future

For example:

You'll miss the bus if you don't hurry!

2. Superstitions

For example:

If you rub a rabbit's foot, it will bring you good luck!

3. Warnings and Threats

For example:

If you don't come to my wedding, I'll never speak to you again.

If you do that again, I will hurt you!

Examples:

- *If Mercury is in retrograde, your computer will malfunction.*
- *If you try to plan any travel, there will be interruptions and delays.*
- *If the retrograde happens during your astrological star sign, you will feel the effects of the retrograde more intensely than most people.*
- *If your horoscope tells you to do something or avoid something, will you follow these commands?*
- *If you spend some time studying your sign and your own personality and relationships, you will see that there is some merit to astrology.*





Learning Points

Modals in the Result Clause

When you use the first conditional, you can choose to use modals in the result clause.

When you use a modal in the result clause, you want to communicate an offer or make a suggestion.

For example:

*If you get a new job, you **should** have a party!*

*My sister **can** get us tickets to the concert if you want to go.*

Look at some other examples from the text:

Examples:

- *If you have to travel during Mercury retrograde, you should give yourself plenty of time and have a back-up plan.*
- *If you need to make any big purchases, like a car or house, you shouldn't make them during this time.*
- *If it's just a small purchase, you can be less wary.*
- *If you need to sign any legal documents or contracts, you ought to wait until the retrograde is over.*
- *If you pay attention to when you have problems, you will see that there is a pattern.*

